

Word-count declaration

Manuscript: *A Comparative Analysis of Relational Database Access-Layer Performance in Express.js for PostgreSQL and MySQL* (submission build `ist/ist_main.tex`).

Counted with `texcount` on the seven body sections plus the structured abstract, with each table and figure counted as 200 words per the IST author guidelines.

Component	Count
Body text (7 sections)	12,898
Structured abstract	298
Tables and figures in the main text (9×200)	1,800
Main-text total	14,996

This is under the journal’s 15,000-word limit. The reference list (70 entries) is provided separately. Twenty tables are placed in the numbered online supplement (`supplement.pdf`, Supplement Tables S1–S20), which is submitted with the manuscript and archived under the same Zenodo DOI as the code and data. In this revision the two cheapest read-pattern tables, the aggregation-pattern table, and the same-SQL control table were moved to the supplement, a resource-footprint (CPU and memory) table and a primary/secondary outcomes table were added to the main text, and four targeted experiments (both-engine open-loop tail, alternative eager-loading sensitivity, MySQL insert commit-flush instrumentation, and a post-restart robustness check) were added as Supplement Tables S17–S20 with a one-sentence pointer each in the body.

Highlights (5 bullets, each ≤ 85 characters) are in `highlights.tex`.